

Open Your *Studio*

A 90-day planner for estheticians going out on their own: the checklists, the numbers and thirteen weeks of focus.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Work through the three checklists before your first client: the paperwork, the room and your prices.
2. Each week has one focus. Do that first; everything else is a bonus.
3. Track your first 25 clients. Where they came from tells you where to spend your time.
4. At the end of each month, fill in the review before you plan the next one.

WHERE I WANT TO BE ON DAY 90

Clients a week _____ Members _____

Money in a month _____ Google reviews _____

Hours a week _____ Days off a week _____

WHY I'M DOING THIS

THE THIRTEEN WEEKS

WEEK	FOCUS
1	Paperwork, insurance and the room
2	Forms, menu and prices
3	Your booking page and profiles
4	The soft launch
5	Doors open
6	Reviews
7	Launch your membership
8	A referral partner
9	Month two review
10	A month of content
11	Your retail shelf
12	Fill the calendar ahead
13	Day 90

Before You *Open*

The paperwork. Requirements differ by state and city, so confirm each one with your state board and city hall.

ITEM	WHERE OR WHO	DONE	DATE
Esthetician license current and displayed		☐	
City or county business license		☐	
Business name registered (DBA), if not your legal name		☐	
EIN from IRS.gov (free), if you'll use one		☐	
Seller's permit, if you'll sell retail		☐	
Professional and general liability insurance		☐	
Business bank account		☐	
Booking and card payments set up		☐	
Suite or room lease reviewed (term, hours, what's included)		☐	
EPA-registered disinfectant, sharps container, first-aid kit		☐	
Intake, consent and policy forms ready		☐	
Bookkeeping set up		☐	
Booking page, Google Business Profile, Instagram link		☐	
Emergency contacts and a plan for a client reaction		☐	

IMPORTANT NUMBERS

License number		Renews	
Insurance policy		Renews	
Business license		Renews	
Seller's permit		Renews	

QUESTIONS FOR MY ACCOUNTANT, INSURER OR LANDLORD

The Room

Everything to have before your first client. Tick what you have, circle what you need.

EQUIPMENT

- | | | |
|---|--|--|
| ☐ Treatment bed | ☐ Stool | ☐ Magnifying lamp |
| ☐ Steamer | ☐ Towel warmer | ☐ Trolley |
| ☐ Wax warmer | ☐ High frequency | ☐ LED device |
| ☐ Disinfection jar | ☐ Linens and blankets | ☐ Bolster |

DISPOSABLES

- | | | |
|-------------------------------------|---|---------------------------------------|
| ☐ Gloves | ☐ Cotton rounds | ☐ Gauze |
| ☐ Spatulas | ☐ Lancets | ☐ Bed roll |
| ☐ Headbands | ☐ Sponges | ☐ Mask brushes |
| ☐ Wax strips | ☐ Blades (if dermaplaning) | ☐ Paper towels |

BACKBAR

- | | | |
|---|--|--|
| ☐ Cleanser | ☐ Enzyme or exfoliant | ☐ Peels |
| ☐ Masks | ☐ Serums | ☐ Moisturizer |
| ☐ Sunscreen | ☐ Massage medium | ☐ Pre- and post-wax |
| ☐ Eye makeup remover | ☐ Toner | ☐ Spot treatment |

YOUR THREE HERO PRODUCTS FOR THE SHELF

PRODUCT	YOUR COST	PRICE	WHY IT'S THE ONE

BUDGET

Equipment	Supplies	Retail
Furniture and decor	Marketing	Total

SHOPPING LIST

Your *Prices*

Price from what an hour has to earn, not from what the studio down the street charges.

WHAT AN HOUR HAS TO EARN

Monthly costs (rent, insurance, software, marketing) _____

Your monthly pay goal _____

Hours you'll treat clients each month _____

Costs + pay, divided by hours = each hour must earn _____

Example: \$1,800 in costs + \$4,000 pay = \$5,800. Over 100 treatment hours, each hour must earn \$58, before product. Most studios book 60 to 70% of their open hours in year one, so plan for that.

YOUR SERVICES

[illegible]

Earns per hour = (price – product cost) ÷ minutes × 60. Anything below your hourly number needs a new price, a shorter time, or a spot as an add-on instead.

Your First 25 Clients

Where they came from tells you where to spend your time.

#	NAME	CAME FROM	FIRST VISIT	REBOOKED	REVIEW	MEMBER
1				☐	☐	☐
2				☐	☐	☐
3				☐	☐	☐
4				☐	☐	☐
5				☐	☐	☐
6				☐	☐	☐
7				☐	☐	☐
8				☐	☐	☐
9				☐	☐	☐
10				☐	☐	☐
11				☐	☐	☐
12				☐	☐	☐
13				☐	☐	☐
14				☐	☐	☐
15				☐	☐	☐
16				☐	☐	☐
17				☐	☐	☐
18				☐	☐	☐
19				☐	☐	☐
20				☐	☐	☐
21				☐	☐	☐
22				☐	☐	☐
23				☐	☐	☐
24				☐	☐	☐
25				☐	☐	☐

Came from: friend or family, past client, Instagram, Google, referral, partner business, walk-by, other.

30 Post Ideas

Never stare at a blank screen. Tick them off as you go.

✓ IDEA

☐ What happens in a facial, in 30 seconds

☐ Your room tour

☐ Meet your esthetician

☐ A myth, busted

☐ Before and after (with consent)

☐ The product I'd buy again

☐ What SPF actually does

☐ Morning routine in 3 steps

☐ Evening routine in 3 steps

☐ A client's question, answered

☐ What a peel feels like

☐ Why I ask about your medications

☐ Brazilian: what to expect

☐ How often to get a facial

☐ Behind the scenes: setting up

✓ IDEA

☐ Your skin in winter

☐ Your skin in summer

☐ A day in the studio

☐ Three signs of a damaged barrier

☐ What I'd never put on my face

☐ The membership, explained

☐ A review, read out loud

☐ Gift card reminder

☐ Last-minute opening

☐ How to prep for your first facial

☐ Aftercare that actually matters

☐ A tool I love and why

☐ Answering "is this normal?"

☐ Your skin at every age

☐ Thank you: what 90 days taught me

YOUR OWN IDEAS

Dates _____

Get every license, permit and policy in order, and set up the treatment room so it's ready for a client.

New clients _____ Rebooked _____

In _____ Out _____

☐

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN

Dates _____

Finish your intake and consent forms, your service menu and your prices. Keep the menu short.

TO DO _____

[illegible]

New clients _____ Rebooked _____

In _____ Out _____

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN

NEXT WEEK _____

Week 3 of 13

Dates _____

This week: Your booking page and profiles
Booking link live, Google Business Profile claimed and verified, Instagram bio updated with the link.

TOP THREE _____

BOOKINGS _____

Goal _____ Booked _____

New clients _____ Rebooked _____

MONEY _____

In _____ Out _____

TO DO _____

✓	TASK
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____

POSTS THIS WEEK _____

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN

WINS _____

NEXT WEEK _____

NOTES

Dates _____

Invite friends, family and past clients. Treat every visit like a real one, and ask each person for honest feedback.

TO DO _____

[illegible]

New clients _____ Rebooked _____

In _____ Out _____

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN

NEXT WEEK

NOTES

Month 1 *Review*

Weeks 1 to 4. Look at the numbers before you look at the feelings.

THE NUMBERS	GOAL	ACTUAL	NOTES
Clients seen			
New clients			
Rebooked before leaving			
Members			
Reviews			
Money in			
Money out			
Kept			

WHAT WORKED	WHAT DIDN'T

CHANGE NEXT MONTH

ONE THING I'M PROUD OF

NOTES

Week 5 of 13

Dates _____

This week: Doors open

Your first full week. Rebook every client before they leave. Note what slowed you down.

TOP THREE _____

BOOKINGS _____

Goal _____ Booked _____

New clients _____ Rebooked _____

MONEY _____

In _____ Out _____

TO DO _____

✓	TASK
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____

POSTS THIS WEEK _____

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN

WINS _____

NEXT WEEK _____

NOTES

Dates _____

Ask every client so far for a Google review, with a direct link. Aim for ten.

New clients _____ Rebooked _____

In _____ Out _____

☐ _____

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN

Week 7 of 13

Dates _____

This week: Launch your membership
Introduce it to every client this week, and send one text to everyone you've seen.

TOP THREE _____

BOOKINGS _____

Goal _____ Booked _____

New clients _____ Rebooked _____

MONEY _____

In _____ Out _____

TO DO _____

✓	TASK
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____

POSTS THIS WEEK _____

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

WINS _____

NEXT WEEK _____

NOTES

Week 8 of 13

Dates _____

This week: A referral partner
Pick one local business (a salon, gym or boutique) and offer to swap referrals.

TOP THREE _____

BOOKINGS _____

Goal _____ Booked _____

New clients _____ Rebooked _____

MONEY _____

In _____ Out _____

TO DO _____

✓	TASK
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____

POSTS THIS WEEK _____

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

WINS _____

NEXT WEEK _____

NOTES

Week 9 of 13

Dates _____

This week: Month two review

Look at the numbers. Adjust prices, hours or services that aren't pulling their weight.

TOP THREE _____

BOOKINGS _____

Goal _____ Booked _____

New clients _____ Rebooked _____

MONEY _____

In _____ Out _____

TO DO _____

✓	TASK
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____

POSTS THIS WEEK _____

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN

WINS _____

NEXT WEEK _____

NOTES

Month 2 *Review*

Weeks 5 to 9. Look at the numbers before you look at the feelings.

THE NUMBERS			
	GOAL	ACTUAL	NOTES
Clients seen			
New clients			
Rebooked before leaving			
Members			
Reviews			
Money in			
Money out			
Kept			

WHAT WORKED	WHAT DIDN'T

CHANGE NEXT MONTH

ONE THING I'M PROUD OF

NOTES

Week 10 of 13

Dates _____

This week: A month of content

Film and write a month of posts in one sitting, then schedule them.

TOP THREE _____

BOOKINGS _____

Goal _____ Booked _____

New clients _____ Rebooked _____

MONEY _____

In _____ Out _____

TO DO _____

✓	TASK
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____

POSTS THIS WEEK _____

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN

WINS _____

NEXT WEEK _____

NOTES

Dates _____

Choose three hero products you use in every facial, and recommend them at checkout.

New clients _____ Rebooked _____

In _____ Out _____

☐ _____

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN

NOTES

Week 12 of 13

Dates _____

This week: Fill the calendar ahead
Make sure every regular has their next two visits booked.

TOP THREE _____

BOOKINGS _____

Goal _____ Booked _____

New clients _____ Rebooked _____

MONEY _____

In _____ Out _____

TO DO _____

✓	TASK
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____

POSTS THIS WEEK _____

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN

WINS _____

NEXT WEEK _____

NOTES

Week 13 of 13

Dates _____

This week: Day 90

Review, celebrate and set goals for the next 90 days.

TOP THREE _____

BOOKINGS _____

Goal _____ Booked _____

New clients _____ Rebooked _____

MONEY _____

In _____ Out _____

TO DO _____

✓	TASK
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____

POSTS THIS WEEK _____

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN

WINS _____

NEXT WEEK _____

NOTES

Month 3 *Review*

Weeks 10 to 13. Look at the numbers before you look at the feelings.

THE NUMBERS	GOAL	ACTUAL	NOTES
Clients seen			
New clients			
Rebooked before leaving			
Members			
Reviews			
Money in			
Money out			
Kept			

WHAT WORKED	WHAT DIDN'T

CHANGE NEXT MONTH

ONE THING I'M PROUD OF

NOTES

Day 90

Look how far you've come.

DAY 1

DAY 90

Clients a week

Members

Money in a month

Google reviews

Instagram followers

WHAT I LEARNED

KEEP DOING

STOP DOING

THE NEXT 90 DAYS

Clients a week Members Money in